

Your first eureka moment.

It was never the tool. It was the approach. Here is the fix, and it takes one sentence longer than what you are doing now.

THE SHIFT

Most people walk up to AI and ask it a question, the way you would ask a search engine. A search engine hands you links. **A thought partner thinks with you.** But it can only think as well as you set it up to, and setting it up takes three things.

Role

Tell it who to be before you ask it anything.

You are a front desk supervisor with fifteen years on the job.

Context

The situation, the background, the constraints, what you already tried.

We are changing the check-in process next month. Some of the team has done it the old way for years.

Output

Name the exact form you need it back in.

A short, warm memo that respects that. Under 200 words.

TWO MOVES THAT CHANGE THE ANSWER

Let it interview you

Stop trying to write the perfect prompt. Say: ask me five questions before you answer. It knows what it needs better than you do.

Ask it to push back

Say: challenge my thinking, and tell me where I am wrong. That turns a cheerleader into an advisor.

Say it out loud

Tap the microphone instead of typing. Same three things, role, context, output, you are just speaking them. You will give it detail you would never bother to type.

YOUR CHALLENGE THIS WEEK

Pick one real thing already on your plate. Give it a role, give it context, tell it what you want back. Then ask it to question you first.

Compare what comes back to what you have been getting. That gap is the whole point.

Before you send anything, read it. You are the pilot. AI is the co-pilot. Every decision still goes through you.

Next episode · **What you are actually allowed to do.** Approved tools, what never goes in a chat box, and who owns what gets sent.

YOUR ORGANIZATION NAME
AND LOGO